

Accelerating skills development in a rapidly evolving TechCo environment

To facilitate our transformation, we believe skills development is integral to every role and we are committed to supporting our employees with comprehensive resources and programmes to develop future skills and grow. Alongside our customer centricity, we are prioritising specialised career skills in software engineering and leadership development.

Developing employee skills

- ✓ During FY2024, we invested R0.5 billion in employee **skills development** across all our markets (FY2023: R0.5 billion).
- ✓ The Vodacom Discover graduate programme equips future Group leaders with the tools and skills for business excellence. The programme runs independently across our markets, offering a well-rounded experience that exposes participants to various company functions. Participants are chosen each year to enter roles within Vodacom.
- ✓ We are enhancing the people data analytics team's capability with the implementation of a global human resources data lake using Google Cloud Platform. This is now live for all OpCos and enables standardised insights and dashboards, reducing the need for manual reporting. This is complemented by high-quality people data managed through the data-quality tool, which checks and corrects human resources data against pre-set rules, with 100% error resolution since its launch in FY2023.
- ✓ We have proudly scaled our transformative RPA and Data Science Citizen Developer programme across all markets. Our Citizen Developer programme is split between RPA and Data Science. To date, 294 delegates have been trained on the RPA Citizen Developer programme across all our markets, 180 of whom are active, with 114 still to be onboarded. The active users have saved the organisation 30 716 hours of using bots. The revenue generated from customers taking up offers the bots suggested added to the outcome. Also, 2 655 calls were prevented due to bots serving our customers.

The Citizen Data Science programme has completed two cohorts and launched its third. To date, 315 candidates have enrolled in the programme, exceeding our target, with 234 individuals successfully trained across all seven markets. These individuals are now actively applying their skills across several business sectors, including technology, commercial, operations, and human resources. In a bid to further enhance their capabilities, 30 participants are undertaking specialised training through programmes like nano-degrees and the Explore AI programme, aiming to qualify as data scientists in training. This effort not only boosts their proficiency but also prepares them for future roles in the industry.

In addition, we plan to provide rotational opportunities to 10 candidates within the data science team in the upcoming fiscal year. This step will offer them practical experience and additional exposure to real-world applications of their training, facilitating a smoother integration into our data-driven projects and enabling them to contribute effectively across various domains.

- ✓ Several awards recognise our efforts to support the youth through our "Discover Graduate" programme in FY2024:
 - Vodacom South Africa won the Employer of Choice award and a Silver award in the Best Integrated Campaign category for employers hiring 20 or more graduates awarded by the South African Graduate Employers Association Employer of Choice award in the telecommunications sector.

- Vodacom South Africa achieved first place in the GradStar Students' Choice award under the Telecommunications sector category. GradStar recognises the Top 100 students across the country based on leadership qualities and work readiness.

Leadership and future-leader development programmes

Our leadership development framework aims to identify and develop the capabilities our leaders need to succeed in their roles and remain relevant to our TechCo's future.

As we strive towards achieving a gender-balanced workforce, we have introduced a few bespoke offerings to unlock the potential of our top talent and below is an overview of some of our signature female programmes.

- ✓ Our newly launched Ignite programme, previously known as our Next Gen Future Leaders programme, aims to build a robust talent pipeline of potential CEOs within our organisation. The programme runs for eight months, and in FY2024, eight candidates also completed the CEO Accelerator Experience Programme. The programme creates a peer community to support and collaborate on common challenges and opportunities.

Female Leadership programme

Our Female Leadership programme was re-launched post-COVID in South Africa. The programme aims to create a network of female professionals with scarce and critical skills who are not employed by Vodacom South Africa. As opportunities arise, the programme offers them employment. Our broader plan is to scale this across the footprint.

YuGrow programme and hyper-personalised learning

In FY2024, we designed a unique programme in South Africa to help our top female talent to reach its full potential. The YuGrow programme is tailored to address the specific challenges that women face in their businesses and empowers them to succeed. This pilot initiative uses a blended Behaviour Tech platform to offer personalised microactions, growth challenges, intelligent coaching, and a support network. We plan to expand this programme to other markets in the future. Furthermore, we are committed to strengthening our succession planning and leadership development. To achieve this, we have implemented a hyper-personalised learning approach for executives, senior leaders, mid-level leaders, frontline leaders, and emerging leaders. This personalised approach aims to enhance their growth experience by identifying their capabilities and gaps and building on them.

- ✓ In FY2024, we rolled out a new talent framework, catering for different talent categories, including top talent, accelerated talent, and critical and scarce skills. Our senior management employees, who are considered top talent, completed psychometric assessments, followed by an in-depth feedback and development discussion. This resulted in individual development plans aimed at accelerating talent development as well as support from a coach through a specialised platform.